

Extending sway monitors

Rohit Goswami · 2024-08-13 · sway · config · wayland · archlinux

For a laptop, assuming the primary screen is always the one it comes with, an easy approach to position screens relatively left and right of the monitor is:

```
# Get display names, -p for plain text
swaymsg -t get_outputs -p | grep Output
Output eDP-1 'Chimei Innolux Corporation 0x1417 Unknown' (focused)
Output DP-1 'Lenovo Group Limited M14 V904H2WF'
# Center the primary display
swaymsg 'output eDP-1 position 0 0'
```

Now we can get the current configuration and move the other screen relative to it.

```
# -r for json format
PRIMARY_WIDTH=$(swaymsg -t get_outputs -r | jq '.[0] | select(.name | contains("eDP")) | .["current_mode"].["width"]')
# Left of primary
swaymsg "output DP-1 position -${PRIMARY_WIDTH} 0"
# Right of primary
swaymsg "output DP-1 position ${PRIMARY_WIDTH} 0"
```

This can be wrapped into a little helper script.